Interim CEO roadmap: a first scaffold

Prepared by Judith Mueller, candidate for Interim CEO · October 2026

A mock-up by a candidate for the Interim CEO role. Not a Verity document.

Initial research so far: built only from the application pack and public information, and to be updated

Sent further to my application, as a scaffold that may be useful whoever is appointed. No reply needed. Verity starts from a position few charities reach, built by volunteers.
A scaffold, not the full roadmap. The first full roadmap would be fleshed out by the end of week 2, tested with every trustee in weeks 3 to 5, and agreed by the Board in week 6.

Figures Real figure · Extrapolation, to be updated · Gap, to be filled

Roadmap Interim CEO days · Trustees or administrator · Waiting on others · Board decision · ★ Milestone

Where it comes from From Verity's application pack · Suggested additions to the pack · A1 to A6 the pack's six accountabilities

Time Before the start (goodwill) · Months 1 to 6 · Months 7 to 12 (optional, to be agreed)

Verity today

initial research, to be updated

MONEY

£88.8k
Income, year to March 2025
Filed accounts

about £100k
Income, latest year (Verity's figure)
Application pack, page 7

81%
Restricted share of 2024/25 income
Filed accounts

£17.2k
Unrestricted income, 2024/25
Filed accounts

£10.5k
Free reserves, 31 March 2025
Filed accounts

£32k to £47k a year
Cost of a permanent 0.6 CEO, fully loaded
My estimate from sector salaries and statutory costs

to be filled
Funders, amounts and end dates
Pre-start questions: documents

to be filled
2025/26 accounts
Due by 31 December 2026

PEOPLE

4
Registered trustees
Charity Commission

to be filled
New trustees who joined in 2026
Pre-start questions: about you

1
Part-time administrator
Application pack

0
Employees
Application pack; filed accounts

to be filled
Trustee time on operations today
Pre-start questions: time log

REACH

12,000+ members
Private Facebook support group
Verity's website

16K followers
Facebook page
Facebook, 17 October 2026

about 46,000
Website visits, 2024/25
Filed accounts

200+
Information packs a year
Filed accounts

9.6 out of 10
PMOS TIME rating by health professionals
Application pack

POSITION

27 January 2027
NICE guideline on PMOS
NICE's own project page

12 May 2026, three-year transition
Renaming to PMOS
Application pack; The Lancet

since April 2025, 10 recommendations
APPG on PMOS
Application pack

James Lind Alliance Top 10
Research priorities
Application pack

SYSTEMS

Donorbox and JustGiving
Online donations
Verity's website

to be filled
Supporter database, finance, HR, files
Pre-start questions: systems list

What needs to get done

Job 1 **An income base that can fund a permanent part-time CEO**
"build an income base that can fund a permanent part-time CEO at the end of the interim period" (pack, page 7)

Job 2 **Ready to employ for the first time**
"put in place the systems and structures that allow Verity to become an employer for the first time" (pack, page 7)

Everything else in the pack "serves those two aims". The six accountabilities and their end-of-contract tests are on the next page.

Key dates

16 November 2026	Rosa closes (4pm)
4 December 2026	The Fore registration closes (midday)
11 January 2027	The Fore application deadline
27 January 2027	NICE guideline expected
31 March 2027	Gift Aid window for 2022/23 donations closes
7 May 2027	The Fore decisions (early May)
1 September 2027	PMOS Awareness Month

The six accountabilities, and Verity's own end-of-contract tests

Every step in the roadmap feeds at least one of these. Progress against each test would be shown here month by month.

1 Financial sustainability and income generation

By the end of the contract: an income strategy agreed by the Board with targets, owners and timescales; a live grants pipeline with a stated value; and a clear picture of the funding secured towards the permanent post and the gap remaining.

0% · not started

Fed by
- ◆ Funding deadlines before January
- ● Income strategy and pipeline
- ● Income streams, including PMOS TIME
- ● Staffing model: people and systems
- ● Business case and funding gap

Pack, page 8

2 Building the infrastructure to become an employer

By the end of the contract: an employer-readiness plan signed off by the Board, providers appointed, and systems documented and in use.

0% · not started

Fed by
- ● Staffing model: people and systems
- ● Employer readiness
- ● Systems mapping and build

Pack, page 8

3 Strategic and operational leadership

By the end of the contract: an agreed roadmap in place within the first six weeks, and trustees spending materially less time on operational delivery than at the start.

0% · not started

Fed by
- ◆ Introductions and pre-start questions
- ● Roadmap and leadership
- ◆ People, skills and resources

Pack, page 8

4 Governance and organisational leadership

By the end of the contract: an agreed scheme of delegation, a consistent Board reporting pack, and clear role descriptions across the team.

0% · not started

Fed by
- ◆ Set-up and compliance
- ● Governance and the Board report
- ◆ People, skills and resources

Pack, page 9

5 Impact, external profile, risk and compliance

By the end of the contract: key relationships mapped and held organisationally, agreed impact measures with baseline data, and a live risk register reviewed at every Board meeting.

0% · not started

Fed by
- ● Impact, relationships and risk
- ● External representation
- ◆ Media and communications capability

Pack, page 9

6 Transition and handover

By the end of the contract: a defined and costed permanent CEO role with a recruitment plan, and a written handover pack completed before the contract ends.

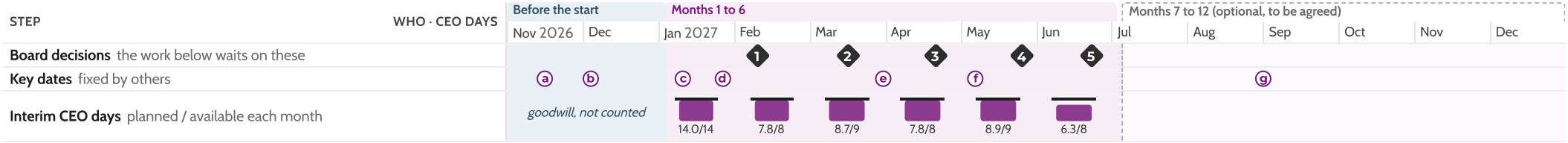
0% · not started

Fed by
- ● Permanent CEO and handover

Pack, page 9

The roadmap: who does what, when, and what it waits on

One row per step, grouped by the two jobs. Solid bars are working time; hatched bars are time spent waiting on someone else (funders, HMRC, providers, the Board). Numbered diamonds are Board decisions the work depends on.



BOARD DECISIONS

1. **Week 6:** Roadmap agreed by the Board, after testing with every trustee
2. **March:** Scheme of delegation agreed; Income strategy agreed
3. **April:** Employer-readiness plan signed off; Staffing model, reserves policy and impact measures
4. **May:** Business case for the permanent post
5. **June:** Month-6 decision: the second half, when to recruit, and media roles and budget

Board decisions could be taken at a meeting or by email, as the Board prefers.

KEY DATES

- (a) 16 November 2026: Rosa closes (4pm)
- (b) 4 December 2026: The Fore registration closes (midday)
- (c) 11 January 2027: The Fore application deadline
- (d) 27 January 2027: NICE guideline expected
- (e) 31 March 2027: Gift Aid window for 2022/23 donations closes
- (f) 7 May 2027: The Fore decisions (early May)
- (g) 1 September 2027: PMOS Awareness Month

WHO IS INVOLVED

- CEO Interim CEO
- Admin with the administrator
- Trustee with one or more trustees
- Board with the whole Board
- Trustee-led led by trustees or the administrator
- External external: funders, HMRC, providers

Interim CEO days available per month: two weeks at five days, then two days a week; months 7 to 12 shown at one day a week (optional). Before the start is goodwill and not counted.

Before the start

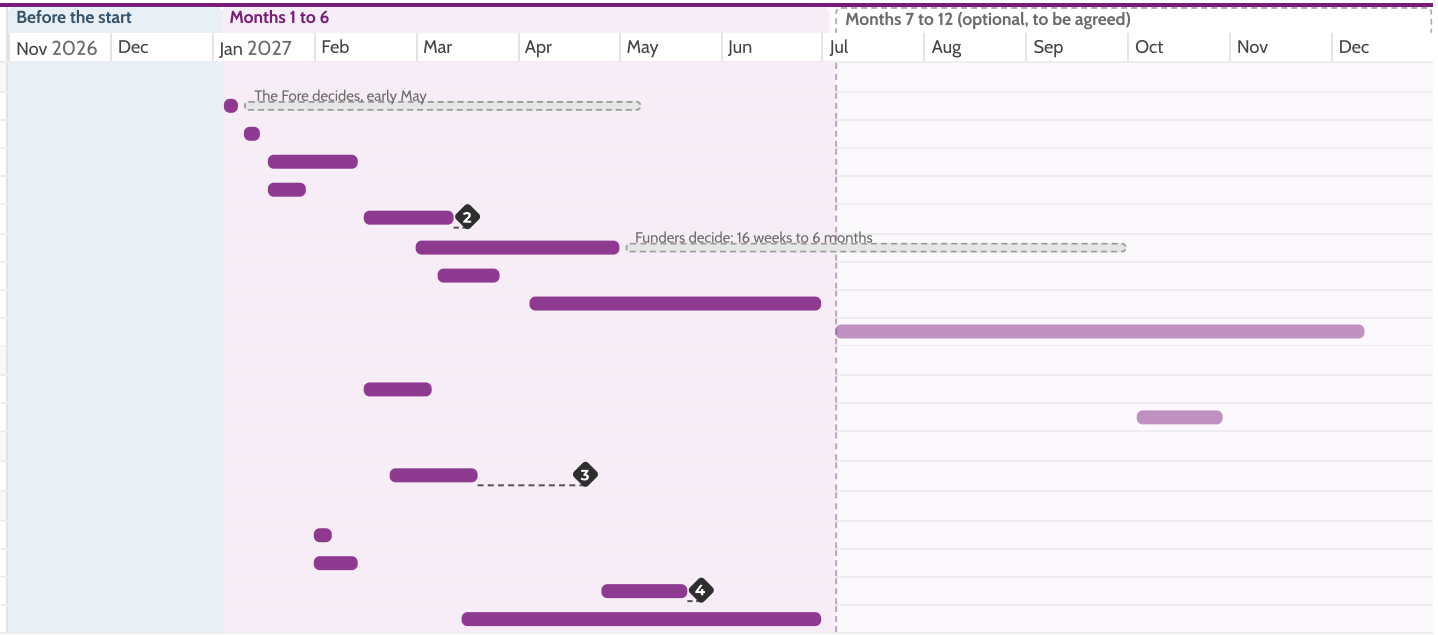
Optional, at times that suit you: introductions and pre-start questions



Job 1: an income base for a permanent CEO

Accountabilities 1 and 2

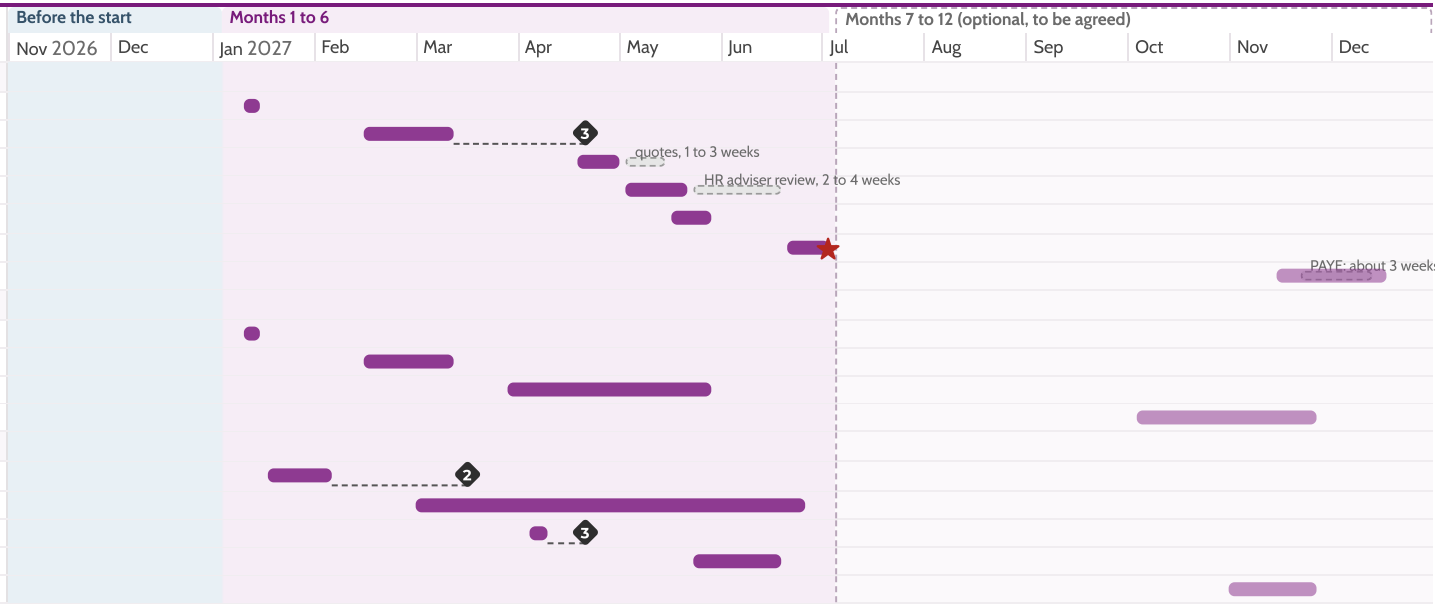
STEP	WHO · CEO DAYS	
Income strategy and pipeline	A1	
The Fore application, if Verity is drawn (deadline 11 J...	CEO Trustee	1 d
Money map: income streams, funders, restricted fu...	CEO Trustee	1 d
Pipeline built on Verity's grant strategy	CEO	1.25 d
NICE moment: patient appeal and a monthly giving...	CEO Trustee	0.5 d
Income strategy, built on the grant strategy	CEO	1.5 d
Applications: Waterloo, Garfield Weston, Big Give; A...	CEO Trustee	4 d
Check all eligible Gift Aid is claimed (2022/23 windo...	CEO Admin	0.5 d
Pipeline and funder relationships, monthly	CEO	2 d
Decisions stewarded; second round; Big Give; Aware...	CEO Trustee	7 d
Income streams, including PMOS TIME	A1	
Income streams review, including growing PMOS TIME inco...	CEO	1 d
PMOS at work: an employer offer, PMOS TIME licences	CEO	1 d
Staffing model: people and systems	A2 A1	
Where Verity needs people, and where systems	CEO Board	1.5 d
Business case and funding gap	A1	
First outline: permanent role and cost range	CEO	0.5 d
Budget and cash-flow forecast, with the Treasurer	CEO Trustee	0.5 d
Costed business case for the permanent post	CEO Trustee	1.5 d
Funding secured and gap remaining, in every Board report	CEO	0.5 d



Job 2: ready to employ

Accountabilities 2 and 4

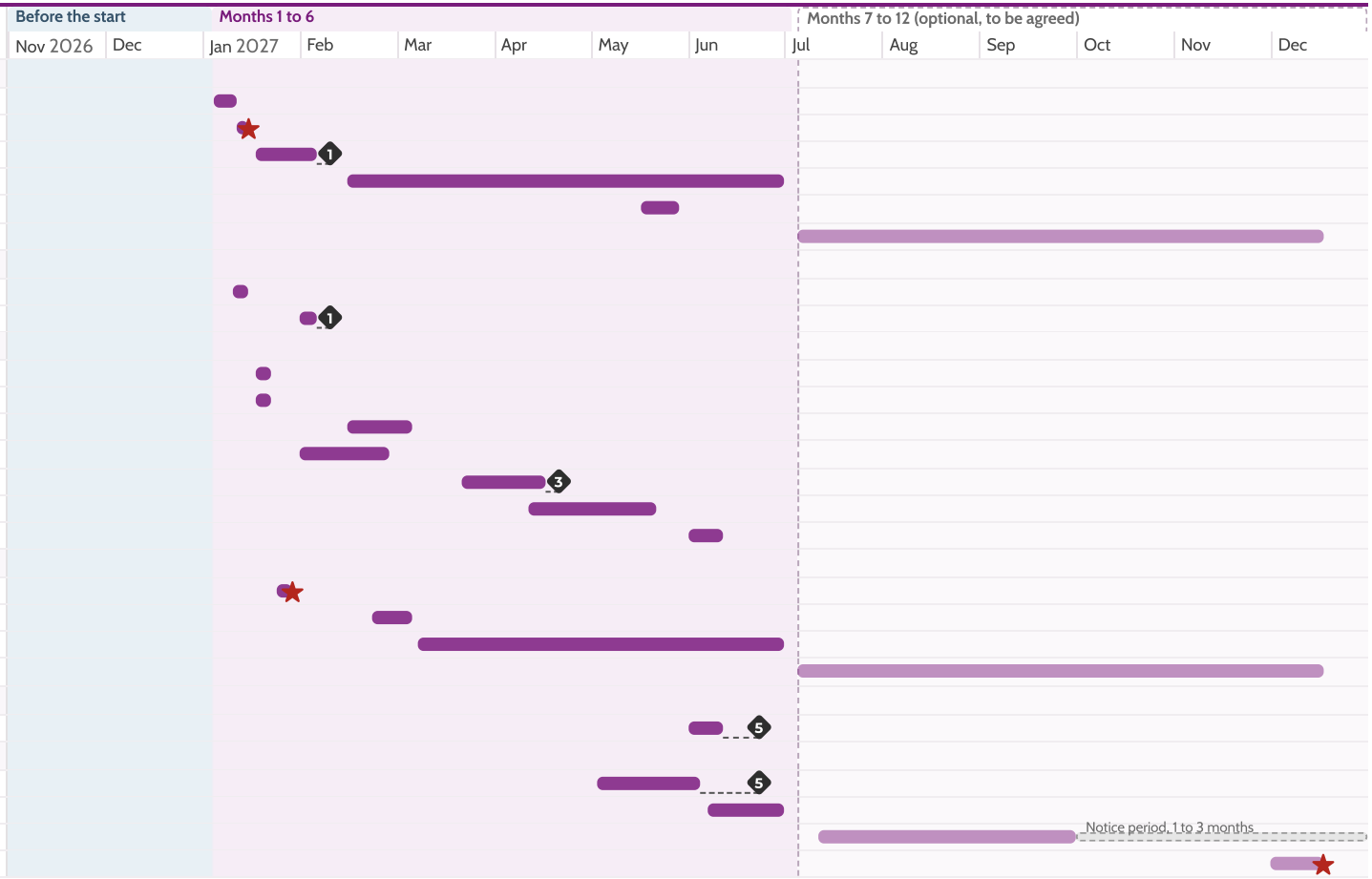
STEP	WHO · CEO DAYS	
Employer readiness	A2	
What exists already, and the administrator's arrange...	CEO Admin	0.5 d
Sequenced, costed employer-readiness plan (indicative costs)	CEO	1.5 d
Formal quotes and choice: payroll, pension, insuran...	CEO External	1 d
Handbook and policies drafted; existing policies upd...	CEO Admin	2.5 d
Roles beyond the CEO, and the order to recruit	CEO Board	0.5 d
Providers appointed; processes written do...	CEO Admin External	1 d
First hire: PAYE, pension, insurance, right to...	CEO Admin External	1.5 d
Systems mapping and build	A2	
Systems map: what we have, would like, and is missi...	CEO Admin	0.5 d
Build or buy plan, incl. a supporter database...	CEO Admin Trustee	1.5 d
First builds; processes written down	CEO Admin	1.5 d
The live dashboard with login and comments; more automat...	CEO	2 d
Governance and the Board report	A4	
Compliance calendar, risk register, conflicts register, Board re...	CEO	1.5 d
The Board report before each meeting, with trustee...	CEO Trustee	2.25 d
Reserves policy	CEO	0.5 d
Role descriptions across the team	CEO Trustee Admin	1 d
Board skills review and renewal plan	CEO Board	1 d



Running and protecting Verity

Accountabilities 3, 5 and 6

STEP	WHO · CEO DAYS	
Roadmap and leadership		A3
Read and assess everything gathered	CEO	3.5 d
First full roadmap, fleshed out from this scaffold	CEO	1 d
Roadmap tested with every trustee	CEO Trustee	2 d
Day-to-day operations moved off trustees; dashbo…	CEO Trustee	1.5 d
Trustee time measured again (a two-week log), …	CEO Trustee-led	0.25 d
Monthly dashboard and Board reporting	CEO	2 d
People, skills and resources	A3	A4
People, skills and resources map, from the pre-start questions	CEO	0.5 d
Gaps and asks agreed: who gives what time	CEO Board	0.5 d
Impact, relationships and risk		A5
Relationship map: who holds what	CEO	0.5 d
Data protection check before the NICE appeal collec…	CEO Admin	0.5 d
Safeguarding review, including the online support gr…	CEO Admin	0.5 d
APPG funding from April 2027	CEO Trustee	0.5 d
Impact measures and baselines, incl. underdiagnosed comm…	CEO	1.5 d
Relationships recorded in the supporter database	CEO Trustee-led	0.5 d
Insurance review for becoming an employer	CEO	0.5 d
External representation		A5
NICE guideline published (27 January): backstage su…	CEO Trustee	0.5 d
Media protocol and spokesperson plan	CEO Trustee	0.5 d
Representation at the pace the Board sets	CEO	1.5 d
More representation, as agreed	CEO	2 d
Media and communications capability		A5
What sustained media work needs: time, skills, budg…	CEO Trustee	1 d
Permanent CEO and handover		A6
Permanent role defined and costed; recruitment plan	CEO Board	1.5 d
Handover pack, if the contract ends at month 6	CEO	1 d
Recruitment: advert by mid-August, interviews in Se…	CEO Board	4 d
Final handover pack; a permanent CEO would start from Jan…	CEO	1 d



Before the start

optional, at times that suit you; goodwill on my side

Contract signed 1

A contract for services. The contract clock starts on 4 January; everything before it is goodwill on my side.

Introductions 2

One-hour calls at times that suit you, with each trustee (including the 2026 trustees) and the administrator.

Notes back 3

Written notes from each call within two days, for each person to add to.

Pre-start questions, optional 4

About you; a two-week time log; a list of systems and who holds each account (no passwords); documents shared once the contract is signed.

Day one 5

A short catch-up with everyone: anything else for my first two weeks.

Pre-start questions for trustees and the administrator (optional)

- **About you:** Your skills, what you do for Verity today, what you would like to do, the time you have for the transition and long term, and your networks.
- **A two-week time log:** What you actually do for Verity, and how long it takes. It gives the baseline for the test in accountability 3.
- **Systems list:** What Verity has, what you would like, what is missing, and who holds each account. No passwords.
- **Documents, once the contract is signed:** Policies, the grant strategy, current figures and grant agreements, key relationships and who holds them, and the media set-up.

Documents would be shared only once the contract is signed, and no passwords at any stage.

Dates before a January start, in case useful

- Rosa, Voices from the Frontline: closes 4pm, 16 November
- The Fore: registration 25 November to midday, 4 December
- Hospital Saturday Fund: 2 December and 5 January
- Early conversation with The Waterloo Foundation

Team and resources

to be filled in from the pre-start questions

Role	Skills	Time for the transition	Time long term	Networks	What they would like to do
Chair	*to be filled*	*to be filled*	*to be filled*	*to be filled*	*to be filled*
Deputy Chair	*to be filled*	*to be filled*	*to be filled*	*to be filled*	*to be filled*
Treasurer	*to be filled*	*to be filled*	*to be filled*	*to be filled*	*to be filled*
Company Secretary	*to be filled*	*to be filled*	*to be filled*	*to be filled*	*to be filled*
Trustees who joined in 2026	*to be filled*	*to be filled*	*to be filled*	*to be filled*	*to be filled*
Administrator (part time)	*to be filled*	*to be filled*	*to be filled*	*to be filled*	*to be filled*
Volunteers	*to be filled*	*to be filled*	*to be filled*	*to be filled*	*to be filled*

What six months can deliver, and what it cannot

Six months at two days a week can deliver properly

- The roadmap agreed by the Board, with people, systems and money mapped
- The Board report, scheme of delegation and risk register in use
- The income strategy agreed, the pipeline live and the first applications in
- The employer-readiness plan signed off, providers chosen and policies drafted
- The permanent CEO role defined and costed, with a recruitment plan
- A handover pack

What it cannot, because of lead times rather than effort

- **The funding for a permanent CEO.** Trust decisions take 16 weeks to 6 months, so applications sent in months 2 to 4 are decided in months 6 to 10.
- **A permanent CEO in post.** A CEO search typically takes around six months, plus one to three months' notice, and it needs the funding to be reasonably clear first.
- **Employer systems fully in use.** They are only truly in use once someone is employed.
- **Trustee-dependent work at full speed.** Board reports need trustees' input, sign-offs wait for Board meetings, and relationship records need every trustee.

The roadmap is therefore modelled on six months, with an optional second half at one day a week, to be discussed and agreed. The table shows what each option would mean in total.

Option	Interim CEO days	Months 7 to 12	A permanent CEO could start
A. Six months as in the pack: two days a week after a two-week ramp-up	56	Trustees lead, with the handover pack	Spring 2028 at the earliest
B. Twelve months at two days a week	about 105	As C, with more capacity for recruitment and income	January 2028
C. Six months as A, then six months at one day a week the roadmap is modelled on this, to be discussed and agreed	about 80	Run the systems, steward funding decisions, recruit, hand over	January to March 2028

The pack offers a six-month contract "with view to extend up to 12 months" (page 12). Day totals are after bank holidays.

Beyond the interim: foundations a permanent team would need (2028 to 2030)

For the Board to shape. A three-year horizon fits multi-year core grants (one to three years), the renaming's managed three-year transition, and a first strategy cycle for a permanent CEO. The longer direction is the mission itself, reviewed every year.

INCOME
Several income streams so that no single funder dominates; multi-year core grants; regular giving; earned income including PMOS TIME; a reserves policy; the APPG funded separately.

PEOPLE
The permanent CEO in post; a staffing map shaped by the people-and-systems decision; clear volunteer roles; media work that does not rest on one person.

GOVERNANCE
Scheme of delegation, Board report and risk register embedded; a Board skills and renewal plan; an annual review.

SYSTEMS
Supporter database; finance, HR and media processes; the dashboard with login and comments; plus additional systems, to be mapped.

MISSION
NICE implementation; the renaming's managed three-year transition, with the new name integrated into the 2028 international guideline update; the APPG's recommendations; the research priorities; reach into underdiagnosed communities.

What this dashboard does now, and what I would add

A snapshot built from public information. It shows what Verity has to deliver and by when, who does what, how many days each step takes, and how long it waits on others, with every figure marked as real, extrapolated or still a gap. Each month the same page would show progress against the plan agreed in week 6.

- **Secure login:** Password-protected access.
- **Comments in one place:** Trustees, the team and invited partners can comment on any item, so all input sits together.
- **One source of truth:** Updated each month from one spreadsheet, so the Board pack is produced, not written.
- **Views for different people:** The Board sees everything, the team their own actions, invited partners only what they are shown.
- **Owners update their own work:** Each owner updates the status of their own steps.
- **A history:** Each month's version is kept, so progress and decisions can be traced.
- **Reminders and export:** Deadline reminders from the calendar, and a PDF for the Board papers.
- **Safe by design:** No personal or health data on the dashboard, and access logged.

Guide to this page

Verity today	Key figures, each coloured by how solid it is: real, an extrapolation to be updated, or a gap to be filled. Hover over a figure for its source.
The two jobs	The two aims the pack says everything else serves.
The six tests	The six accountabilities, each with Verity's own words for what must be true by the end of the contract. Progress bars start at zero.
The roadmap	Steps grouped by job and workstream. Each shows who is involved and how many Interim CEO days it takes. Solid bars are working time, hatched bars are waiting time, and numbered diamonds are Board decisions the work depends on.
Where it comes from	● marks workstreams the pack asks for; ◆ marks suggested additions. A1 to A6 are the pack's six accountabilities.
Interim CEO days	Planned days against the days available each month. Before the start is goodwill and not counted.
Months 7 to 12	Optional: what I would aim to deliver if time and funding allow, to be discussed and agreed.
Before the start	Optional: one-hour introduction calls, notes back, and pre-start questions, so that day one starts with what is needed.
Team and resources	One row per role, filled in from the pre-start questions: skills, time now and long term, and networks.

Sources

- **Verity Interim CEO application pack and advert**: September 2026
- **Verity's filed accounts to 31 March 2025**: Charity Commission, charity 1097599
- **Charity Commission and Companies House registers**: read 16 October 2026
- **NICE project page GID-NG10436**: expected publication 27 January 2027, read 17 October 2026
- **Register of All-Party Parliamentary Groups**: 1 September 2026 edition
- **Funders' own websites**: The Fore, Rosa, Hospital Saturday Fund, Garfield Weston, National Lottery Awards for All, Big Give, read 6 to 16 October 2026
- **The Waterloo Foundation annual report 2025**: page 16
- **GOV.UK employer guidance**: PAYE, workplace pensions, employers' liability insurance, right to work; read 16 October 2026
- **Verity's website and social media pages**: read 16 and 17 October 2026